

Name: _____
(COMPLETED)

Chapter 1 - Theories

For each trait, describe how it explains our cognitions (thoughts) and behaviors, as well as any important people associated with the perspective

Perspective	Focus / How it explains thoughts and behaviors	Important People
Biological/ Neuroscience	Behavior and mental processes arise from physiological activity — hormones, genes, brain structures, and brain activity. Closely tied to neuroscience, the study of the brain and nervous system.	Modern neuroscientists collectively (the chapter features brain-mapper Narayanan "Bobby" Kasthuri); classic names: Roger Sperry, Michael Gazzaniga
Developmental	How thoughts and behaviors grow and change across the lifespan — physical, cognitive, and social development; asks how nature and nurture shape development and whether change is gradual or stage-like.	Jean Piaget, Erik Erikson, Lev Vygotsky, G. Stanley Hall
Cognitive	Behavior is driven by mental processes — thinking, memory, language, decision making; studies how we take in, process, store, and retrieve information. The 1950s "cognitive revolution" brought the mind back after behaviorism. New direction: cognitive neuroscience.	George Miller (memory, "7 plus or minus 2")
Psychodynamic	Modern descendant of Freud's theory: unconscious processes and early life experiences shape thoughts and behavior — with less emphasis on sexual drives and more on relationships and unrecognized motives.	Sigmund Freud (root of the tradition); neo-Freudians: Carl Jung, Alfred Adler, Karen Horney, Erik Erikson

Perspective	Focus / How it explains thoughts and behaviors	Important People
Humanistic	Human nature is by and large positive, and people naturally grow in a positive direction; thoughts and behaviors are explained by growth, free choice, and self-determination. A reaction against psychoanalysis and behaviorism; set the stage for positive psychology.	Carl Rogers, Abraham Maslow
Behavioral	Behavior is primarily learned from the environment — through associations (classical conditioning), rewards and punishments (operant conditioning), and observation. Only observable, measurable behavior should be studied; strong nurture position.	Ivan Pavlov (classical conditioning), John B. Watson (founded behaviorism), B.F. Skinner (operant conditioning)
Social-cultural	Other people and the broader cultural context shape behavior and mental processes — parents, teachers, peers, social interactions, and cultural norms. Cross-cultural research (1980s) showed Western participants do not represent all cultures.	Lev Vygotsky
Evolutionary	Thoughts, emotions, and behaviors are shaped by natural selection: inherited traits that helped ancestors survive and reproduce became more common; maladaptive traits faded.	Charles Darwin (natural selection), David Buss (modern evolutionary psychology)
Psychoanalytic	Behavior and personality are shaped by unconscious conflicts between inner desires (often sexual and aggressive) and society's expectations; early childhood experiences with caregivers are key. Produced psychoanalysis, the original "talk therapy." (Note the "Freud Problem": famous, but weak scientific support.)	Sigmund Freud
Biopsychosocial	Thoughts and behaviors are explained by the interaction of biological (genes, hormones, brain), psychological (thoughts, emotions, learning), and social/cultural factors — an integrated, multi-lens approach used across disciplines.	Integrative framework rather than one founder (George Engel proposed the model, 1977)